Payscribe Bill Checkout API Requirements

Requested backend/API scope for enabling a hosted bills checkout at checkout.payscribe.co.

Purpose

The hosted bill checkout should let a merchant create a checkout session from their backend, redirect a customer to checkout.payscribe.co, and allow the customer to complete a bill purchase through a Payscribe-managed checkout UI.

The checkout page must never receive a Payscribe secret API key. All calls that require merchant authentication, wallet debit, vending, requery, and sensitive status handling should be handled by Payscribe backend APIs or by a merchant backend using the Payscribe SDK.

Current Assets Already Available

Area	Current capability
Node.js SDK	Typed wrappers for virtual accounts, virtual cards, and bills payment APIs.
Bills SDK	Supports airtime, data, electricity, cable TV, betting, internet, epins, international bills, SMS, airtime-to-wallet, and transaction requery.
Hosted checkout UI	Static HTML checkout page at hosted-checkout/index.html. It can load a session, collect bill details, validate details, confirm payment, and show the result.
Swagger/consumer tooling	Local Swagger playground and typed consumer test server for SDK endpoint testing.

Required Payscribe APIs

These APIs are the recommended native Payscribe APIs needed to support a complete hosted checkout product.

Method	Path	Purpose
POST	/checkout/sessions	Create a checkout session and return a checkout URL.
GET	/checkout/sessions/:sessionId	Return safe public session data for the hosted checkout page.
POST	/checkout/sessions/:sessionId/validate	Validate customer-entered bill details before final payment.
POST	/checkout/sessions/:sessionId/confirm	Execute the selected bill payment and finalize the checkout attempt.

GET	/checkout/sessions/:sessionId/status	Return final or current checkout status for polling, reconciliation, and merchant support.

Create Checkout Session

Endpoint: POST /checkout/sessions

Called by the merchant backend before redirecting the customer. This endpoint should authenticate with the merchant secret key, create the session, lock the intended amount/rules, and return a hosted checkout URL.

```
{
  "reference": "order_123",
  "amount": 5000,
  "currency": "NGN",
  "customer": {
    "name": "Ada Lovelace",
    "email": "ada@example.com",
    "phone": "08012345678"
  },
  "allowedCategories": ["electricity", "data", "airtime", "cable"],
  "successUrl": "https://merchant.com/success",
  "cancelUrl": "https://merchant.com/cancel",
  "metadata": {
    "orderId": "order_123"
  }
}

{
  "id": "chk_123",
  "checkoutUrl": "https://checkout.payscribe.co/chk_123",
  "status": "open",
  "expiresAt": "2026-07-24T15:30:00.000Z"
}
```

Load Checkout Session

Endpoint: GET /checkout/sessions/:sessionId

Called by the hosted checkout page when opened by the customer. It should only return public-safe data needed to render the checkout. It must not return secret keys, wallet details, internal auth tokens, or sensitive merchant configuration.

```
{
  "id": "chk_123",
  "merchantName": "Demo Merchant",
  "amount": 5000,
  "currency": "NGN",
  "customer": {
    "name": "Ada Lovelace",
    "email": "ada@example.com",
    "phone": "08012345678"
  },
  "allowedCategories": ["electricity", "data", "airtime", "cable"],
  "status": "open",
  "expiresAt": "2026-07-24T15:30:00.000Z"
}
```

Validate Bill Details

Endpoint: POST /checkout/sessions/:sessionId/validate

Called after the customer enters bill details. It should route validation based on category. Electricity validates meter information, cable validates smartcard information, and data/airtime can validate or normalize recipient and provider details where supported.

```
{
  "category": "electricity",
  "provider": "phedc",
  "meterNumber": "45083082250",
  "meterType": "prepaid",
  "amount": 1000
}

{
  "valid": true,
  "customerName": "Ada Lovelace",
  "address": "12 Broad Street, Lagos"
}
```

Confirm Checkout

Endpoint: POST /checkout/sessions/:sessionId/confirm

Called when the customer confirms the payment. It should execute the actual bill payment, update the checkout session status, make the operation idempotent by session/reference, and return the transaction result.

```
{
  "category": "electricity",
  "provider": "phedc",
  "meterNumber": "45083082250",
  "meterType": "prepaid",
  "amount": 1000,
  "customerName": "Ada Lovelace",
  "phone": "08012345678"
}

{
  "status": "success",
  "reference": "order_123",
  "transactionId": "txn_123",
  "token": "1234-5678-9012"
}
```

Get Checkout Status

Endpoint: GET /checkout/sessions/:sessionId/status

Used by the checkout page and merchant systems for polling, reconciliation, and support. The response should expose the current state without leaking internal processing details.

```
{
  "id": "chk_123",
  "status": "success",
  "reference": "order_123",
  "transactionId": "txn_123",
  "paidAt": "2026-07-24T15:10:00.000Z"
}
```

Expected Process Flow

Step	Action
1	Merchant backend calls POST /checkout/sessions.
2	Payscribe returns checkoutUrl such as https://checkout.payscribe.co/chk_123.
3	Merchant redirects the customer to the checkout URL.
4	Hosted checkout page calls GET /checkout/sessions/:sessionId.
5	Customer selects bill category and enters bill details.
6	Hosted checkout page calls POST /validate.
7	Customer reviews validated details and confirms.
8	Hosted checkout page calls POST /confirm.
9	Payscribe executes the bill transaction and updates the checkout status.
10	Payscribe redirects to successUrl or cancelUrl and sends merchant webhook events.

Required Webhook Events

Event	Meaning
checkout.session.completed	Checkout completed successfully.
checkout.session.failed	Checkout failed after a confirmation attempt.
checkout.session.expired	Checkout expired before completion.
bill.payment.success	Underlying bill payment succeeded.
bill.payment.failed	Underlying bill payment failed.
bill.payment.pending	Underlying bill payment is pending final confirmation.

SDK Integration

The Node.js SDK should expose a higher-level checkout resource once the Payscribe APIs exist. This resource should sit above the current lower-level bills APIs.

```
const session = await payscribe.checkout.sessions.create({
  reference: "order_123",
  amount: 5000,
  currency: "NGN",
  allowedCategories: ["electricity", "data", "airtime", "cable"],
  successUrl: "https://merchant.com/success",
  cancelUrl: "https://merchant.com/cancel"
});
```

Security And Product Requirements

Requirement	Details
No browser secret keys	The checkout page must never expose merchant secret keys.
Idempotency	Confirm calls should be safe to retry by session ID/reference.
Expiry	Checkout sessions should expire and reject late confirmation.
Status states	Recommended states: open, validating, confirmed, success, pending, failed, expired, canceled.
Category controls	Merchants should restrict allowed bill categories per session.
Metadata	Merchant metadata should be stored and returned in webhooks.
Redirects	Support successUrl and cancelUrl after completion or cancellation.
Webhook signing	All webhook events should be signed for merchant verification.

Minimum Request To Payscribe Team

Please provide native hosted checkout session APIs for bills payment with the following endpoints: POST /checkout/sessions, GET /checkout/sessions/:sessionId, POST /checkout/sessions/:sessionId/validate, POST /checkout/sessions/:sessionId/confirm, and GET /checkout/sessions/:sessionId/status.

These APIs will allow the open-source SDK and static checkout UI to provide a Stripe-like checkout experience while keeping all sensitive credentials and transaction execution server-side.